

» WATERFOWL

**AMERICAN WIGEON***Mareca americana*

F: Anatidae

This species feeds by dabbling on the surface of shallow waters and occasionally up-ends. Huge flocks winter in the Caribbean after breeding in N. America.

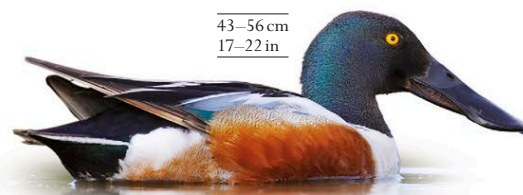
cream, black,
and green
head pattern

45–56 cm
18–22 in

**BAIKAL TEAL***Sibirionetta formosa*

F: Anatidae

This distinctive duck breeds in cold, open forest in Siberia on the edge of the tundra, and migrates to E. Asia in the winter.

**NORTHERN SHOVELER***Spatula clypeata*

F: Anatidae

Both sexes of dabbling (surface-feeding) ducks typically have a coloured wing-patch called a speculum. This widespread wetland species of the northern hemisphere has a green speculum.

55–65 cm
22–26 in

**INDIAN RUNNER***Anas platyrhynchos*

F: Anatidae

A domestic descendant of the wild mallard, this long-necked breed originated in the Malay Peninsula and India in the 19th century.

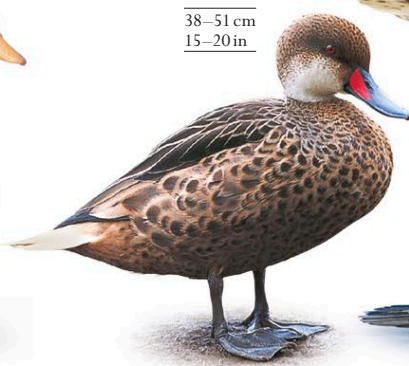
50–65 cm
20–26 in

**DOMESTIC DUCK***Anas platyrhynchos*

F: Anatidae

Most domesticated ducks have descended from the mallard. They are raised for their meat, eggs, or down, or kept for ornamental purposes.

38–51 cm
15–20 in

**WHITE-CHEEKED PINTAIL***Anas bahamensis*

F: Anatidae

This saltwater dabbling duck is found in S. American estuaries and mangrove swamps. Unlike temperate northern pintails, both sexes look alike.

50–65 cm
20–26 in

**MALLARD***Anas platyrhynchos*

F: Anatidae

Widespread in the northern hemisphere, the surface-feeding mallard can interbreed with related species, perhaps indicating that this group has only recently evolved.

33–40 cm
13–16 in

**BUFFLEHEAD***Bucephala albeola*

F: Anatidae

The smallest sea duck in N. America, the bufflehead nests in tree-holes and sometimes uses those vacated by woodpeckers.

orange cheek
plumes

**MANDARIN DUCK***Aix galericulata*

F: Anatidae

Wrongly thought to be monogamous, this tree-nesting duck is a symbol of love in its native northeastern Asia. It has been introduced in Europe and California.

41–51 cm
16–20 in

38–51 cm
15–20 in

**HARLEQUIN DUCK***Histrionicus histrionicus*

F: Anatidae

A highly buoyant sea duck, this species rides choppy waters and nests beside fast-flowing streams in eastern N. America, Iceland, and western Russia.

43–51 cm
17–20 in

**WOOD DUCK***Aix sponsa*

F: Anatidae

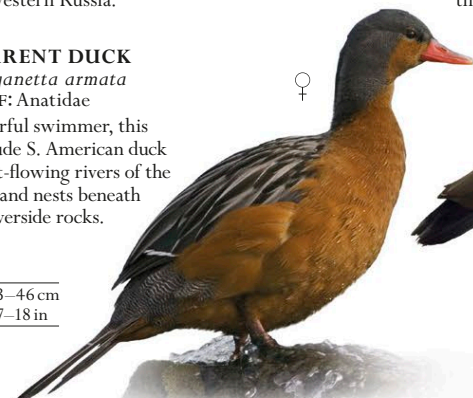
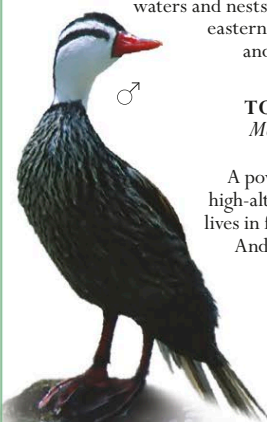
The newly hatched chicks of this N. American tree-perching duck jump down from their nests in high tree-holes to reach the water below.

TORRENT DUCK*Merganetta armata*

F: Anatidae

A powerful swimmer, this high-altitude S. American duck lives in fast-flowing rivers of the Andes and nests beneath riverside rocks.

43–46 cm
17–18 in

**RINGED TEAL***Callonetta leucophrys*

F: Anatidae

Like other tropical ducks, this S. American teal is not migratory and retains its plumage colours throughout the year.

white flank
patch

35–38 cm
14–15 in

